User Manual

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BCIS Subscription Billing and Collection System — deliverable D4. How to use the desktop application day to day. Menus you do not see are outside your role's permissions; ask the Owner if you need one.

1. Signing in

1. Start **BCIS Billing**.
2. **First time on this PC only:** below the sign-in button, check *Server:* …. If it does not show the office server, click **Change**, enter `http://<server-address>:3000` (ask IT), and click **Test & Save**. The address is checked before it is saved and remembered on this PC.
3. Enter your username (or email) and password, then **Sign in**.
4. After 5 wrong passwords in a row the account locks for 15 minutes. The Owner can unlock it sooner (*Administration → Users → unlock icon*).
5. After 15 minutes without activity the screen locks; enter your password to continue. Use the door icon (top right) to sign out.

Find anything quickly: the search box at the top of every screen (Ctrl+K) finds a subscriber by account number, name, phone, address, invoice number, receipt number or GCash reference.

2. Roles

Role	Main tasks
Owner / Super Admin	Everything, including users, permissions, audit log and backup/restore
Administrator	Subscribers, plans, service accounts, billing, collections, reports
Cashier	Find subscribers, receive payments, print receipts, record GCash submissions
Collection Supervisor	Collectors, areas & routes, batches, remittance, settings
Accounting / Auditor	GCash verification, reversals, voids, adjustments, reports, audit log
Technician	Service accounts, suspension and reconnection work
Read-only Viewer	Dashboard and reports only

The Owner can change exactly what each role may do in *Administration → Roles & Permissions*. The server enforces these rules on every action; hiding a menu item is never the safeguard.

3. Subscribers and services

New subscriber: *Subscribers → New Subscriber*. Fill in the account number, name, contact details, address and any notes; required fields are marked *. Subscribers are never deleted — set them to inactive instead.

Subscriber profile: *Subscribers → All Subscribers →* eye icon. Tabs: Overview, Services, Billing, Payments, Ledger (with Statement of Account), Collection, Service History, Documents (uploaded proofs) and Audit.

Add a service: profile → *Services* → **Add Service** (or *Subscribers* → *Service Accounts* → *New*). Choose the plan, enter a service number, and optionally an installation address (if different), a billing start date, a due day (1–28) and an account-specific rate. Leave the rate blank to bill the plan price.

Plans: *Services* → a service → plans. Each plan has a code, monthly price, installation fee, reconnection fee and speed and/or channel count. Changing a price affects only invoices generated afterwards.

4. Billing

Monthly billing run: *Billing → Generate Billing*.

1. Add the billing period if it does not exist (label, start, end, due date).
2. Click **Generate** on the period. The window shows how many active accounts are not yet billed.
3. Optionally tick **Create as drafts** to review before billing.
4. Click **Generate N Invoice(s)**. Running it again never creates duplicates — already-billed accounts are skipped.

The first invoice for a new account includes the plan's installation fee; a completed reconnection's fee is added to the next invoice.

Current Billing lists the invoices of the current period; **Invoices** lists all with search and status filter. Open an invoice to:

- **Finalize** a draft (it then counts as billed);
- **Adjust** — a credit (e.g. outage) or debit (extra charge) with a reason;
- **Void** — with a reason; only possible when no posted payment is applied (reverse those payments first);
- **Print** the invoice.

Statuses: Draft, Unpaid, Partially Paid, Paid, Overdue, Void, Credited. Invoices become Overdue automatically after their due date; **Mark Overdue** runs that check immediately.

5. Receiving a payment (cashier)

Payments → Receive Payment:

1. **Find account** — type the account number, name, phone, invoice or receipt number; click the account.
2. **Balance** — the outstanding and overdue amounts are shown, and the amount is pre-filled with the full balance.
3. **Payment** — enter the amount and method (Cash, GCash, Bank Transfer, Cheque, Other). For non-cash methods, add the reference and attach the proof file (PNG, JPEG, WEBP or PDF up to 5 MB).
4. **Allocation preview** — shows which invoices the money will pay, oldest first, and the balance afterwards. Any excess is kept as advance credit.
5. **Post Payment** — the system assigns the official receipt number (OR-…). Click **Print Receipt**, then **Next Payment**.

A posted payment is never edited or deleted. If it was wrong, an authorized user opens it (*Payment History*) and clicks **Reverse** with a reason; the invoices' balances are restored and both records stay visible.

6. GCash verification

1. The cashier records a GCash payment in *Receive Payment* with method **GCash**, the 13-digit reference from the customer's screenshot, and the screenshot file. It is held as **pending** — nothing is applied yet. A reference already used is refused.
2. A reviewer (Accounting/Owner/Admin) opens *Payments → GCash Verification*. The left pane lists pending submissions; the right pane shows the screenshot, amount, reference and account. A warning appears if the same image was uploaded before.
3. Check the payment in the GCash business account, then **Verify & Post** (allocates it) or **Reject** with a reason. You cannot review a submission you entered yourself.

7. Ledger and Statement of Account

Profile → *Ledger*, or *Service Accounts* → an account. The ledger lists every charge, payment, adjustment, reversal and void in date order with a running balance. Click **Statement of Account**, choose **From**/**To** dates, and **Print Statement**: it shows the opening balance, the period's activity and the closing balance. *Reports* can export it as PDF/XLSX.

8. House-to-house collection

Set-up: *Collections → Areas & Routes* and *Collectors*. Assign each service account to an area and collector. A collector's **route sheet** (Collectors → route icon) lists account, address, current bill, arrears and total due, ready to print.

Batch lifecycle:

1. *Collection Batches → New Batch* — the collector's route and amounts due are captured at this moment (expected receivable).
2. **Add Payment** for each collection recorded (status becomes *In Progress*).
3. **Submit Batch** when the collector returns; no more collections can be added.
4. **Record Remittance** — enter the cash actually handed over. Only cash is compared; GCash and other non-cash collections are shown separately. Any shortage or overage is calculated and kept.
5. **Reconcile** — if there is a difference you must tick the acknowledgement and write an explanation. It is never reset to balanced.
6. **Close Batch** (Supervisor/Admin/Owner) — the final sign-off.

Remittance lists batches waiting for their cash.

9. Receivables and overdue monitoring

Receivables: **Outstanding** and **Overdue** invoice lists (filter by aging bucket), **Aging** totals (Current, 1–30, 31–60, 61–90, 90+ days — they add up to the outstanding total) and **Suspension Candidates**. The dashboard shows overdue alerts and AR aging at a glance.

10. Suspension and reconnection

Open the service account:

- **Suspend Account** — enter the reason and notes; your name and the date are recorded.
- **Reconnect Account** — allowed only when no overdue balance remains (collect payment first). The fee defaults to the plan's reconnection fee. Assign a technician and **Request Reconnection**; the account stays suspended until the technician (or office) clicks **Mark Completed**. Tick *Reconnected now* when no field visit is needed. The Owner/Admin may override an unpaid balance with a reason; this is audited.

Every change appears under *Service History*. Grace period and suspension threshold are set in *Administration → Settings*.

11. Reports

Reports. **Management reports**: collection summary (daily, weekly, monthly, annual, by method), billing vs collection, revenue by plan/service/ area, subscriber master list, collector assignments, remittance, reversals/ voids/adjustments, voided receipts, user activity and audit trail. Set the parameters, **Run** to view, or **Export PDF/XLSX**. **Statements & summaries**: dashboard summary, collection report, AR report, aging, collector performance, ledger and Statement of Account.

12. Administration (Owner)

- **Users** — create users, assign roles, reset passwords, unlock, deactivate.
- **Roles & Permissions** — tick which roles hold each permission; **Save**.
- **Audit Log** — every recorded change with filters; click a row for the old/new values. Audit records cannot be edited.
- **Settings** — grace period and suspension threshold.
- **Backup & Restore** — **Create Backup** (database plus uploaded proofs), **Verify** (re-checks the dump and every proof file), **Restore** (replaces the live data; requires confirmation — anything entered after the backup is lost).

13. Troubleshooting

Symptom	What to do
"Could not reach the BCIS server" at sign-in	Check the network cable/Wi-Fi and the *Server* address on the sign-in screen; ask IT whether the server PC is on.
"Too many failed sign-in attempts"	Wait 15 minutes or ask the Owner to unlock your account.
A menu item is missing	Your role does not have that permission — ask the Owner.
"An invoice already exists for this service account and billing period"	It is already billed for that period (duplicate protection).
"Duplicate receipt number or GCash reference"	That GCash reference was already submitted — look it up with the search box.
Cannot void an invoice	A posted payment is applied to it; reverse the payment first.

Symptom	What to do
Cannot reconnect	An overdue balance remains; receive the payment first.
Wrong payment posted	Never edit it — use **Reverse** with a reason.
Batch will not reconcile	There is a shortage/overage: tick the acknowledgement and write the explanation.
Screen locked	Normal after 15 minutes idle; enter your password.